Unit 10 — Travelling by Train

Track E · Klasse 6 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can understand a station announcement.*
- *I can read a train timetable and find a connection with one change.*
- *I can buy a ticket using polite phrases.*

Lead-in I

Sam and Lina are at the station with three large rucksacks. The train is delayed by twelve minutes. They have read every poster on the platform twice. Mr. Flint has bought tea from a small kiosk and looks suspiciously content. ”This,” he says, ”is the proper way to start a journey.”

Reading I

Vocabulary — train travel
platform, ticket office, single (BrE) / one-way (AmE), return (BrE) / round-trip (AmE), connection, departure, arrival, delay, cancelled, on time, lost property, the guard, the ticket inspector, the trolley, the waiting room, off-peak / peak.

Reading — a small timetable

From → To	Departure	Arrival	Platform
Stuttgart → Karlsruhe	09:14	09:53	5
Karlsruhe → Strasbourg	10:08	10:54	1

Reading II

From → To	Departure	Arrival	Platform
Strasbourg → Paris	11:24	13:00	8

Buying a ticket

- *A return to Karlsruhe, please.*
- *Single or return?*
- *That's £18.50.*

Reading III

- *Which platform? — Platform 5.*
- *When is the next train to …?*
- *Is the train on time?*

Practise I

Niveau E — controlled

1. From the timetable: which platform for Karlsruhe? When does the train to Strasbourg leave?
2. Match: single — one-way; return — round-trip; delayed — late; cancelled — not running.

Niveau E — productive

3. Build a ticket-buying dialogue: 8 polite lines.

Your turn I

Pair role-play — *At the Ticket Office (Niveau E)*. Two minutes. Customer asks for a ticket, a platform, and the next train; clerk answers. Polite forms.

Sample
— Hello, a return to Karlsruhe, please. Off-peak, if possible. — That's £18.50. Platform 5. The next train is in 12 minutes. — Thank you very much.

Reflect I

- I can understand a station announcement.
- I can read a small timetable and find a connection.
- I can run an 8-line ticket-buying dialogue.

Further reading / listening I

- National Rail Enquiries (UK) — example timetables.
- BBC Learning English — *At the station*.